CAUTION **Quantum measurement misconceptions** If we measure the particle to have $p_x = \hbar k_n$, does that mean it had $p_x = \hbar k_n$ before the measurement? No; the particle acquired that value as a result of the measurement. If we measure the particle to have $p_x = \hbar k_n$ instead of $p_x = -\hbar k_n$, does that mean there was some bias in the way we did the measurement? Again, no; the result of any given experiment is random. All quantum mechanics can do is predict the probability that this experiment will give us a certain result.

Note that not every measurement of a quantum-mechanical system causes a change in the wave function. If we perform an experiment that measures only the *energy* of a particle given by the wave function in Eq. (40.53), the wave function does *not* change. That's because the wave function already corresponds to a state of definite energy $E_n = \hbar\omega_n$, so there is a 100% probability that we'll measure that value of energy.

You may ask, Does the wave function really collapse? Many physicists would answer yes, but some theorists have devised alternative models of what happens in a quantum-mechanical measurement. One model, called the *many-worlds interpretation,* asserts that there is a *universal* wave function that describes all particles in the universe. Whenever a measurement of any sort takes place, whether of human origin (like our experiment) or natural origin (for example, a photon of sunlight scattering from an electron in an atom in the atmosphere), this universal wave function does not collapse. Instead, every measurement causes the universe to branch into alternative timelines. So, when we carry out the experiment depicted in Fig. 40.30, the universe splits into one timeline in which the photon goes into detector A and a second timeline in which the photon goes into detector B. These two timelines then no longer communicate.

As weird as these aspects of quantum mechanics are, others are far weirder. We'll investigate these in Chapter 41 after we have learned more about the nature of the electron.

TEST YOUR UNDERSTANDING OF SECTION 40.6 A particle in a box is described by a wave function that is a combination of the $n = 1$ and $n = 2$ stationary states: $\Psi(x, t) = C\psi_1(x)e^{-iE_1t/\hbar} + D\psi_2(x)e^{-iE_2t/\hbar}$, where $\psi_1(x)$ and $\psi_2(x)$ are given by Eq. (40.35), E_1 and E_2 are given by Eq. (40.31), and C and D are nonzero constants. If you carry out an experiment to measure the energy of this particle, the result is *guaranteed* to be (i) E_1; (ii) E_2; (iii) $(E_1 + E_2)/2$; (iv) intermediate between E_1 and E_2, with a value that depends on the values of C and D; (v) none of these.

ANSWER

(v) The value of the energy of a particle in a box must be equal to one of the allowed energy levels, so the measured value will be either E_1 or E_2. *Neither* of these results is guaranteed. If $|C| = |D|$, then E_1 and E_2 are of equal probability. E_1 is the more likely result if $|C| > |D|$, and E_2 is the more likely result if $|C| < |D|$.

CHAPTER 40 SUMMARY

Wave functions: The wave function for a particle contains all of the information about that particle. If the particle moves in one dimension in the presence of a potential-energy function $U(x)$, the wave function $\Psi(x, t)$ obeys the one-dimensional Schrödinger equation. (For a *free* particle on which no forces act, $U(x) = 0$.) The quantity $|\Psi(x, t)|^2$, called the probability distribution function, determines the relative probability of finding a particle near a given position at a given time. If the particle is in a state of definite energy, called a stationary state, $\Psi(x, t)$ is a product of a function $\psi(x)$ that depends on only spatial coordinates and a function $e^{-iEt/\hbar}$ that depends on only time. For a stationary state, the probability distribution function is independent of time.

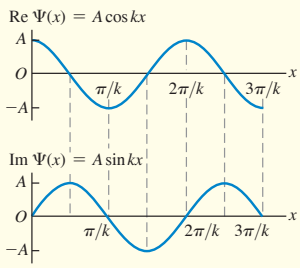
A spatial stationary-state wave function $\psi(x)$ for a particle that moves in one dimension in the presence of a potential-energy function $U(x)$ satisfies the time-independent Schrödinger equation. More complex wave functions can be constructed by superposing stationary-state wave functions. These can represent particles that are localized in a certain region, thus representing both particle and wave aspects. (See Examples 40.1 and 40.2.)

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m}\frac{\partial^2\Psi(x, t)}{\partial x^2} + U(x)\Psi(x, t) = i\hbar\frac{\partial\Psi(x, t)}{\partial t} \quad (40.20)$$

(general 1-D Schrödinger equation)

$$\Psi(x, t) = \psi(x)e^{-iEt/\hbar} \quad (40.21)$$

(time-dependent wave function for a state of definite energy)



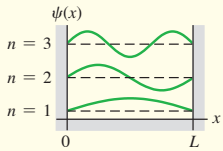
$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m}\frac{d^2\psi(x)}{dx^2} + U(x)\psi(x) = E\psi(x) \quad (40.23)$$

(time-independent 1-D Schrödinger equation)

Particle in a box: The energy levels for a particle of mass m in a box (an infinitely deep square potential well) with width L are given by Eq. (40.31). The corresponding normalized stationary-state wave functions of the particle are given by Eq. (40.35). (See Examples 40.3 and 40.4.)

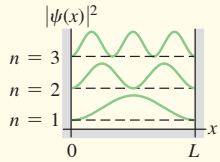
$$E_n = \frac{p_n^2}{2m} = \frac{n^2h^2}{8mL^2} = \frac{n^2\pi^2\hbar^2}{2mL^2} \quad (n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots) \tag{40.31}$$

$$\psi_n(x) = \sqrt{\frac{2}{L}} \sin \frac{n\pi x}{L} \quad (n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots) \tag{40.35}$$

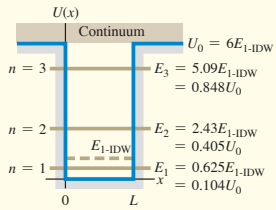


Wave functions and normalization: To be a solution of the Schrödinger equation, the wave function $\psi(x)$ and its derivative $d\psi(x)/dx$ must be continuous everywhere except where the potential-energy function $U(x)$ has an infinite discontinuity. Wave functions are usually normalized so that the total probability of finding the particle somewhere is unity.

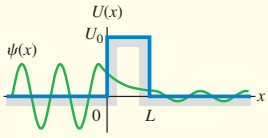
$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |\psi(x)|^2\, dx = 1 \quad \text{(normalization condition)} \tag{40.33}$$



Finite potential well: In a potential well with finite depth U_0, the energy levels are lower than those for an infinitely deep well with the same width, and the number of energy levels corresponding to bound states is finite. The levels are obtained by matching wave functions at the well walls to satisfy the continuity of $\psi(x)$ and $d\psi(x)/dx$. (See Examples 40.5 and 40.6.)

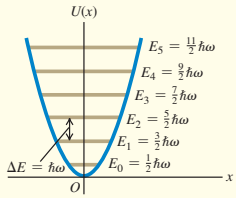


Potential barriers and tunneling: There is a certain probability that a particle will penetrate a potential-energy barrier even though its initial energy is less than the barrier height. This process is called tunneling. (See Example 40.7.)



Quantum harmonic oscillator: The energy levels for the harmonic oscillator (for which $U(x) = \frac{1}{2}k'x^2$) are given by Eq. (40.46). The spacing between any two adjacent levels is $\hbar\omega$, where $\omega = \sqrt{k'/m}$ is the oscillation angular frequency of the corresponding Newtonian harmonic oscillator. (See Example 40.8.)

$$E_n = \left(n + \tfrac{1}{2}\right)\hbar\sqrt{\frac{k'}{m}} = \left(n + \tfrac{1}{2}\right)\hbar\omega \quad (n = 0, 1, 2, 3, \ldots) \tag{40.46}$$



Measurement in quantum mechanics: If the wave function of a particle does not correspond to a definite value of a certain physical property (such as momentum or energy), the wave function changes when we measure that property. This phenomenon is called wave-function collapse.

Chapter 40 Media Assets

For assigned homework and other learning materials, go to Mastering Physics.

GUIDED PRACTICE

KEY EXAMPLE VARIATION PROBLEMS

Be sure to review EXAMPLES 40.3 and 40.4 (Section 40.2) before attempting these problems.

VP40.4.1 The lowest energy level for an electron confined to a one-dimensional box is 2.00×10^{-19} J. Find (a) the width of the box and (b) the energies of the $n = 2$ and $n = 3$ energy levels.

VP40.4.2 A proton (mass 1.67×10^{-27} kg) is confined to a one-dimensional box of width 5.00×10^{-15} m. Find the energy difference between (a) the $n = 2$ and $n = 1$ energy levels and (b) the $n = 3$ and $n = 2$ energy levels.

VP40.4.3 A photon is emitted when an electron in a one-dimensional box transitions from the $n = 2$ energy level to the $n = 1$ energy level.

The wavelength of this photon is 655 nm. Find (a) the energy of this photon, (b) the width of the box, and (c) the wavelength of the photon emitted when the electron transitions from the $n = 3$ level to the $n = 2$ level.

VP40.4.4 A wave function for a particle in a box with energy E is

$$\psi(x) = A\cos\left(\frac{x\sqrt{2mE}}{\hbar} + \phi\right)$$

(a) Find the second derivative of $\psi(x)$ and show that this function satisfies the Schrödinger equation. (b) Use the boundary condition at $x = 0$ to determine the value of ϕ. (c) Use the boundary condition at $x = L$ to determine the value of E.

Be sure to review EXAMPLE 40.6 (Section 40.3) before attempting these problems.

VP40.6.1 An electron is confined to a potential well of width 0.350 nm. (a) Find the ground-level energy $E_{1-\text{IDW}}$ if the well is infinitely deep. If instead the depth U_0 of the well is six times the value of $E_{1-\text{IDW}}$, find (b) the ground-level energy and (c) the minimum energy required to free the electron from the well.

VP40.6.2 A finite potential well has a depth U_0 that is six times greater than the ground-level energy $E_{1-\text{IDW}}$ of an electron in an infinitely deep well of the same width. The photon emitted when an electron in the finite potential well transitions from the $n = 3$ level to the $n = 2$ level has energy 2.50×10^{-19} J. Find (a) the value of $E_{1-\text{IDW}}$, (b) the value of U_0, and (c) the width of the potential well.

VP40.6.3 An electron in a finite potential well can emit a photon of only one of three different wavelengths when it makes a transition from one energy level to a lower energy level. The depth of this potential well is six times greater than the ground-level energy $E_{1-\text{IDW}}$ that the electron would have if the well had the same width but was infinitely deep. (a) If the shortest of the three wavelengths is 355 nm, find the quantum numbers n for the initial and final electron energy levels for this transition. (b) Find the other two wavelengths and the quantum numbers n of the initial and final energy levels for each transition.

VP40.6.4 An electron is in a potential well that is 0.400 nm wide. (a) Find the ground-level energy of the electron $E_{1-\text{IDW}}$, in eV, if the potential well is infinitely deep. (b) If the depth of the potential is only 0.015 eV, much less than $E_{1-\text{IDW}}$, there is only one bound state. Find the energy, in eV, of this bound state.

Be sure to review EXAMPLE 40.7 (Section 40.4) before attempting these problems.

VP40.7.1 An electron of energy 3.75 eV encounters a potential barrier 6.10 eV high. Find the probability that the electron will tunnel through the barrier if the barrier width is (a) 0.750 nm and (b) 0.500 nm.

VP40.7.2 A 3.50 eV electron encounters a barrier with height 4.00 eV. Find (a) the probability that the electron will tunnel through the barrier if its width is 0.800 nm and (b) the barrier width that gives twice the tunneling probability you found in part (a).

VP40.7.3 A potential barrier is 5.00 eV high and 0.900 nm wide. Find the probability that an electron will tunnel through this barrier if its energy is (a) 4.00 eV, (b) 4.30 eV, and (c) 4.60 eV.

VP40.7.4 There is a 1-in-417 probability that an electron with energy 3.00 eV will tunnel through a barrier with height 5.00 eV. Find the width of the barrier.

BRIDGING PROBLEM A Packet in a Box

A particle of mass m in an infinitely deep well (see Fig. 40.9) has the following wave function in the region from $x = 0$ to $x = L$:

$$\Psi(x, t) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\psi_1(x)e^{-iE_1t/\hbar} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\psi_2(x)e^{-iE_2t/\hbar}$$

Here $\psi_1(x)$ and $\psi_2(x)$ are the normalized stationary-state wave functions for the first two levels ($n = 1$ and $n = 2$), given by Eq. (40.35). E_1 and E_2, given by Eq. (40.31), are the energies of these levels. The wave function is zero for $x < 0$ and for $x > L$. (a) Find the probability distribution function for this wave function. (b) Does $\Psi(x, t)$ represent a stationary state of definite energy? How can you tell? (c) Show that the wave function $\Psi(x, t)$ is normalized. (d) Find the angular frequency of oscillation of the probability distribution function. What is the interpretation of this oscillation? (e) Suppose instead that $\Psi(x, t)$ is a combination of the wave functions of the two lowest levels of a finite well of length L and height U_0 equal to six times the energy of the lowest-energy bound state of an infinite well of length L. What would be the angular frequency of the probability distribution function in this case?

SOLUTION GUIDE

IDENTIFY and SET UP

1. In Section 40.1 we saw how to interpret a combination of two free-particle wave functions of different energies. In this problem you need to apply these same ideas to a combination of wave functions for the infinite well (Section 40.2) and the finite well (Section 40.3).

EXECUTE

2. Write down the full time-dependent wave function $\Psi(x, t)$ and its complex conjugate $\Psi^*(x, t)$ by using the functions $\psi_1(x)$ and $\psi_2(x)$ from Eq. (40.35). Use these to calculate the probability distribution function, and decide whether or not this function depends on time.
3. To check for normalization, you'll need to verify that when you integrate the probability distribution function from step 2 over all values of x, the integral is equal to 1. [*Hint:* The trigonometric identities $\sin^2\theta = \frac{1}{2}(1 - \cos 2\theta)$ and $\sin\theta\sin\phi = \cos(\theta - \phi) - \cos(\theta + \phi)$ may be helpful.]
4. To find the answer to part (d) you'll need to identify the oscillation angular frequency ω_{osc} in your expression from step 2 for the probability distribution function. To interpret the oscillations, draw graphs of the probability distribution functions at times $t = 0$, $t = T/4$, $t = T/2$, and $t = 3T/4$, where $T = 2\pi/\omega_{\text{osc}}$ is the oscillation period of the probability distribution function.
5. For the finite well you do not have simple expressions for the first two stationary-state wave functions $\psi_1(x)$ and $\psi_2(x)$. However, you can still find the oscillation angular frequency ω_{osc}, which is related to the energies E_1 and E_2 in the same way as for the infinite-well case. (Can you see why?)

EVALUATE

6. Why are the factors of $1/\sqrt{2}$ in the wave function $\Psi(x, t)$ important?
7. Why do you suppose the oscillation angular frequency for a finite well is lower than for an infinite well of the same width?

PROBLEMS

•, ••, •••: Difficulty levels. **CP**: Cumulative problems incorporating material from earlier chapters. **CALC**: Problems requiring calculus. **DATA**: Problems involving real data, scientific evidence, experimental design, and/or statistical reasoning. **BIO**: Biosciences problems.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Q40.1 If quantum mechanics replaces the language of Newtonian mechanics, why don't we have to use wave functions to describe the motion of macroscopic objects such as tennis balls and cars?

Q40.2 A student remarks that the relationship of ray optics to the more general wave picture is analogous to the relationship of Newtonian mechanics, with well-defined particle trajectories, to quantum mechanics. Comment on this remark.

Q40.3 As Eq. (40.21) indicates, the time-dependent wave function for a stationary state is a complex number having a real part and an imaginary part. How can this function have any physical meaning, since part of it is *imaginary*?

Q40.4 Why must the wave function of a particle be normalized?

Q40.5 If a particle is in a stationary state, does that mean that the particle is not moving? If a particle moves in empty space with constant momentum $\vec{p}$ and hence constant energy $E = p^2/2m$, is it in a stationary state? Explain your answers.

Q40.6 For the particle in a box, we chose $k = n\pi/L$ with $n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots$ to fit the boundary condition that $\psi = 0$ at $x = L$. However, $n = 0, -1, -2, -3, \ldots$ also satisfy that boundary condition. Why didn't we also choose those values of n?

Q40.7 If ψ is normalized, what is the physical significance of the area under a graph of $|\psi|^2$ versus x between x_1 and x_2? What is the total area under the graph of $|\psi|^2$ when all x are included? Explain.

Q40.8 For a particle in a box, what would the probability distribution function $|\psi|^2$ look like if the particle behaved like a classical (Newtonian) particle? Do the actual probability distributions approach this classical form when n is very large? Explain.

Q40.9 In Chapter 15 we represented a standing wave as a superposition of two waves traveling in opposite directions. Can the wave functions for a particle in a box also be thought of as a combination of two traveling waves? Why or why not? What physical interpretation does this representation have? Explain.

Q40.10 A particle in a box is in the ground level. What is the probability of finding the particle in the right half of the box? (Refer to Fig. 40.12, but don't evaluate an integral.) Is the answer the same if the particle is in an excited level? Explain.

Q40.11 The wave functions for a particle in a box (see Fig. 40.12a) are zero at certain points. Does this mean that the particle can't move past one of these points? Explain.

Q40.12 For a particle confined to an infinite square well, is it correct to say that each state of definite energy is also a state of definite wavelength? Is it also a state of definite momentum? Explain. (*Hint:* Remember that momentum is a vector.)

Q40.13 For a particle in a finite potential well, is it correct to say that each bound state of definite energy is also a state of definite wavelength? Is it a state of definite momentum? Explain.

Q40.14 In Fig. 40.12b, the probability function is zero at the points $x = 0$ and $x = L$, the "walls" of the box. Does this mean that the particle never strikes the walls? Explain.

Q40.15 A particle is confined to a finite potential well in the region $0 < x < L$. How does the area under the graph of $|\psi|^2$ in the region $0 < x < L$ compare to the total area under the graph of $|\psi|^2$ when including all possible x?

Q40.16 Compare the wave functions for the first three energy levels for a particle in a box of width L (see Fig. 40.12a) to the corresponding wave functions for a finite potential well of the same width (see Fig. 40.15a). How does the wavelength in the interval $0 \le x \le L$ for the $n = 1$ level of the particle in a box compare to the corresponding wavelength for the $n = 1$ level of the finite potential well? Use this to explain why E_1 is less than $E_{1-\text{IDW}}$ in the situation depicted in Fig. 40.15b.

Q40.17 It is stated in Section 40.3 that a finite potential well always has at least one bound level, no matter how shallow the well. Does this mean that as $U_0 \to 0$, $E_1 \to 0$? Does this violate the Heisenberg uncertainty principle? Explain.

Q40.18 Figure 40.15a shows that the higher the energy of a bound state for a finite potential well, the more the wave function extends outside the well (into the intervals $x < 0$ and $x > L$). Explain why this happens.

Q40.19 In classical (Newtonian) mechanics, the total energy E of a particle can never be less than the potential energy U because the kinetic energy K cannot be negative. Yet in barrier tunneling (see Section 40.4) a particle passes through regions where E is less than U. Is this a contradiction? Explain.

Q40.20 Figure 40.17 shows the scanning tunneling microscope image of 48 iron atoms placed on a copper surface, the pattern indicating the density of electrons on the copper surface. What can you infer about the potential-energy function inside the circle of iron atoms?

Q40.21 Qualitatively, how would you expect the probability for a particle to tunnel through a potential barrier to depend on the height of the barrier? Explain.

Q40.22 The wave function shown in Fig. 40.20 is nonzero for both $x < 0$ and $x > L$. Does this mean that the particle splits into two parts when it strikes the barrier, with one part tunneling through the barrier and the other part bouncing off the barrier? Explain.

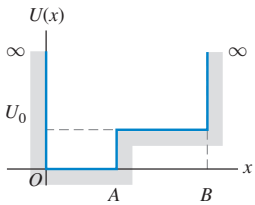
Q40.23 The probability distributions for the harmonic-oscillator wave functions (see Figs. 40.27 and 40.28) begin to resemble the classical (Newtonian) probability distribution when the quantum number n becomes large. Would the distributions become the same as in the classical case in the limit of very large n? Explain.

Q40.24 In Fig. 40.28, how does the probability of finding a particle in the center half of the region $-A < x < A$ compare to the probability of finding the particle in the outer half of the region? Is this consistent with the physical interpretation of the situation?

Q40.25 Compare the allowed energy levels for the hydrogen atom, the particle in a box, and the harmonic oscillator. What are the values of the quantum number n for the ground level and the second excited level of each system?

Q40.26 Sketch the wave function for the potential-energy well shown in **Fig. Q40.26** when E_1 is less than U_0 and when E_3 is greater than U_0.

Figure **Q40.26**



Q40.27 (a) A particle in a box has wave function $\Psi(x, t) = \psi_2(x)e^{-iE_2t/\hbar}$, where ψ_n and E_n are given by Eqs. (40.35) and (40.31), respectively. If the energy of the particle is measured, what is the result? (b) If instead the particle has wave function $\Psi(x, t) = (1/\sqrt{2})(\psi_1(x)e^{-iE_1t/\hbar} + \psi_2(x)e^{-iE_2t/\hbar})$ and the energy of the particle is measured, what is the result? (c) If we had many identical particles with the wave function of part (b) and measured the energy of each, what would be the average value of all of the measurements? Can we say that, before the measurement was made, each particle had this average energy? Explain.

EXERCISES

Section 40.1 Wave Functions and the One-Dimensional Schrödinger Equation

40.1 • An electron is moving as a free particle in the $-x$-direction with momentum that has magnitude 4.50×10^{-24} kg · m/s. What is the one-dimensional time-dependent wave function of the electron?

40.2 • A free particle moving in one dimension has wave function

$$\Psi(x, t) = A[e^{i(kx-\omega t)} - e^{i(2kx-4\omega t)}]$$

where k and ω are positive real constants. (a) At $t = 0$ what are the two smallest positive values of x for which the probability function $|\Psi(x, t)|^2$ is a maximum? (b) Repeat part (a) for time $t = 2\pi/\omega$. (c) Calculate v_{av} as the distance the maxima have moved divided by the elapsed time. Compare your result to the expression $v_{av} = (\omega_2 - \omega_1)/(k_2 - k_1)$ from Example 40.1.

40.3 • Consider the free-particle wave function of Example 40.1. Let $k_2 = 3k_1 = 3k$. At $t = 0$ the probability distribution function $|\Psi(x, t)|^2$ has a maximum at $x = 0$. (a) What is the smallest positive value of x for which the probability distribution function has a maximum at time $t = 2\pi/\omega$, where $\omega = \hbar k^2/2m$? (b) From your result in part (a), what is the average speed with which the probability distribution is moving in the $+x$-direction? Compare your result to the expression $v_{av} = (\omega_2 - \omega_1)/(k_2 - k_1)$ from Example 40.1.

40.4 • A particle is described by a wave function $\psi(x) = Ae^{-\alpha x^2}$, where A and α are real, positive constants. If the value of α is increased, what effect does this have on (a) the particle's uncertainty in position and (b) the particle's uncertainty in momentum? Explain your answers.

40.5 • Consider a wave function given by $\psi(x) = A \sin kx$, where $k = 2\pi/\lambda$ and A is a real constant. (a) For what values of x is there the highest probability of finding the particle described by this wave function? Explain. (b) For which values of x is the probability *zero*? Explain.

40.6 • **CALC** Let ψ_1 and ψ_2 be two solutions of Eq. (40.23) with energies E_1 and E_2, respectively, where $E_1 \neq E_2$. Is $\psi = A\psi_1 + B\psi_2$, where A and B are nonzero constants, a solution to Eq. (40.23)? Explain your answer.

Section 40.2 Particle in a Box

40.7 • An electron is in a one-dimensional box. When the electron is in its ground state, the longest-wavelength photon it can absorb is 420 nm. What is the next longest-wavelength photon it can absorb, again starting in the ground state?

40.8 •• **CALC** A particle moving in one dimension (the x-axis) is described by the wave function

$$\psi(x) = \begin{cases} Ae^{-bx}, & \text{for } x \geq 0 \\ Ae^{bx}, & \text{for } x < 0 \end{cases}$$

where $b = 2.00\ \text{m}^{-1}$, $A > 0$, and the $+x$-axis points toward the right. (a) Determine A so that the wave function is normalized. (b) Sketch the graph of the wave function. (c) Find the probability of finding this particle in each of the following regions: (i) within 50.0 cm of the origin, (ii) on the left side of the origin (can you first guess the answer by looking at the graph of the wave function?), (iii) between $x = 0.500$ m and $x = 1.00$ m.

40.9 • **Ground-Level Billiards.** (a) Find the lowest energy level for a particle in a box if the particle is a billiard ball ($m = 0.20$ kg) and the box has a width of 1.3 m, the size of a billiard table. (Assume that the billiard ball slides without friction rather than rolls; that is, ignore the *rotational* kinetic energy.) (b) Since the energy in part (a) is all kinetic, to what speed does this correspond? How much time would it take at this speed for the ball to move from one side of the table to the other? (c) What is the difference in energy between the $n = 2$ and $n = 1$ levels? (d) Are quantum-mechanical effects important for the game of billiards?

40.10 • A proton is in a box of width L. What must the width of the box be for the ground-level energy to be 4.9 MeV, a typical value for the energy with which the particles in a nucleus are bound? Compare your result to the size of a nucleus—that is, on the order of 10^{-14} m.

40.11 •• Find the width L of a one-dimensional box for which the ground-state energy of an electron in the box equals the absolute value of the ground state of a hydrogen atom.

40.12 •• When a hydrogen atom undergoes a transition from the $n = 2$ to the $n = 1$ level, a photon with $\lambda = 122$ nm is emitted. (a) If the atom is modeled as an electron in a one-dimensional box, what is the width of the box in order for the $n = 2$ to $n = 1$ transition to correspond to emission of a photon of this energy? (b) For a box with the width calculated in part (a), what is the ground-state energy? How does this correspond to the ground-state energy of a hydrogen atom? (c) Do you think a one-dimensional box is a good model for a hydrogen atom? Explain. (*Hint:* Compare the spacing between adjacent energy levels as a function of n.)

40.13 •• A certain atom requires 3.5 eV of energy to excite an electron from the ground level to the first excited level. Model the atom as an electron in a box and find the width L of the box.

40.14 • An electron in a one-dimensional box has ground-state energy 2.00 eV. What is the wavelength of the photon absorbed when the electron makes a transition to the second excited state?

40.15 • A particle with mass m is in a one-dimensional box with width L. If the energy of the particle is $9\pi^2\hbar^2/2mL^2$, (a) what is the linear momentum of the particle and (b) what is the ratio of the width of the box to the de Broglie wavelength λ of the particle?

40.16 • Recall that $|\psi|^2 dx$ is the probability of finding the particle that has normalized wave function $\psi(x)$ in the interval x to $x + dx$. Consider a particle in a box with rigid walls at $x = 0$ and $x = L$. Let the particle be in the ground level and use ψ_n as given in Eq. (40.35). (a) For which values of x, if any, in the range from 0 to L is the probability of finding the particle zero? (b) For which values of x is the probability highest? (c) In parts (a) and (b) are your answers consistent with Fig. 40.12? Explain.

40.17 • Consider two different particles in two different boxes. Particle A has nine times the mass of particle B, while particle B's box has twice the width of particle A's box. What are the two lowest quantum numbers for the two systems for which particles A and B have equal energies?

40.18 • (a) Find the excitation energy from the ground level to the third excited level for an electron confined to a box of width 0.360 nm. (b) The electron makes a transition from the $n = 1$ to $n = 4$ level by absorbing a photon. Calculate the wavelength of this photon.

40.19 • An electron is in a box of width 3.4×10^{-10} m. What are the de Broglie wavelength and the magnitude of the momentum of the electron if it is in (a) the $n = 1$ level; (b) the $n = 2$ level; (c) the $n = 3$ level? In each case how does the wavelength compare to the width of the box?

40.20 •• When an electron in a one-dimensional box makes a transition from the $n = 1$ energy level to the $n = 2$ level, it absorbs a photon of wavelength 426 nm. What is the wavelength of that photon when the electron undergoes a transition (a) from the $n = 2$ to the $n = 3$ energy level and (b) from the $n = 1$ to the $n = 3$ energy level? (c) What is the width L of the box?

40.21 • A particle is in a box with infinitely rigid walls. The walls are at $x = -L/2$ and $x = +L/2$. (a) Show that $\psi_n = A \cos k_n x$ is a possible solution. What must k_n equal? (b) Show that $\psi_n = A \sin k_n x$ is a possible solution. What must k_n equal? (c) What are the allowed energy levels for $\psi_n = A \sin k_n x$ and for $\psi_n = A \cos k_n x$? (d) How does the set of energy levels you found in part (c) compare to the energy levels given by Eq. (40.31)?

Section 40.3 Potential Wells

40.22 •• An electron is moving past the square well shown in Fig. 40.13. The electron has energy $E = 3U_0$. What is the ratio of the de Broglie wavelength of the electron in the region $x > L$ to the wavelength for $0 < x < L$?

40.23 • An electron is bound in a square well of depth $U_0 = 6E_{1-\text{IDW}}$. What is the width of the well if its ground-state energy is 2.40 eV?

40.24 •• An electron is in the ground state of a square well of width $L = 4.00 \times 10^{-10}$ m. The depth of the well is six times the ground-state energy of an electron in an infinite well of the same width. What is the kinetic energy of this electron after it has absorbed a photon of wavelength 72 nm and moved away from the well?

40.25 •• An electron is bound in a square well of width 1.00 nm and depth $U_0 = 6E_{1-\text{IDW}}$. If the electron is initially in the ground level and absorbs a photon, what maximum wavelength can the photon have and still liberate the electron from the well?

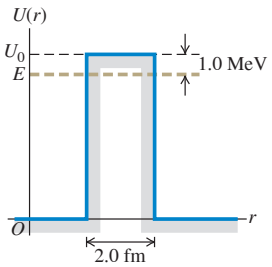
40.26 •• An electron is bound in a square well that has a depth equal to six times the ground-level energy $E_{1-\text{IDW}}$ of an infinite well of the same width. The longest-wavelength photon that is absorbed by this electron has a wavelength of 400 nm. Determine the width of the well.

40.27 •• A proton is bound in a square well of width 4.5 fm = 4.5×10^{-15} m. The depth of the well is six times the ground-level energy $E_{1-\text{IDW}}$ of the corresponding infinite well. If the proton makes a transition from the level with energy E_1 to the level with energy E_3 by absorbing a photon, find the wavelength of the photon.

Section 40.4 Potential Barriers and Tunneling

40.28 •• **Alpha Decay.** In a simple model for a radioactive nucleus, an alpha particle ($m = 6.64 \times 10^{-27}$ kg) is trapped by a square barrier that has width 2.0 fm and height 30.0 MeV. (a) What is the tunneling probability when the alpha particle encounters the barrier if its kinetic energy is 1.0 MeV below the top of the barrier (**Fig. E40.28**)? (b) What is the tunneling probability if the energy of the alpha particle is 11.0 MeV below the top of the barrier?

Figure E40.28



40.29 •• (a) An electron with initial kinetic energy 32 eV encounters a square barrier with height 41 eV and width 0.25 nm. What is the probability that the electron will tunnel through the barrier? (b) A proton with the same kinetic energy encounters the same barrier. What is the probability that the proton will tunnel through the barrier?

40.30 • An electron with initial kinetic energy 5.0 eV encounters a barrier with height U_0 and width 0.60 nm. What is the transmission coefficient if (a) $U_0 = 7.0$ eV; (b) $U_0 = 9.0$ eV; (c) $U_0 = 13.0$ eV?

40.31 • An electron with initial kinetic energy 5.7 eV encounters a barrier with height 10.8 eV. What is the probability of tunneling if the width of the barrier is (a) 0.85 nm and (b) 0.40 nm?

40.32 •• An electron is moving past the square barrier shown in Fig. 40.19, but the energy of the electron is *greater* than the barrier height. If $E = 2U_0$, what is the ratio of the de Broglie wavelength of the electron in the region $x > L$ to the wavelength for $0 < x < L$?

Section 40.5 The Harmonic Oscillator

40.33 • A wooden block with mass 0.300 kg is oscillating on the end of a spring that has force constant 100 N/m. Calculate the ground-level energy and the energy separation between adjacent levels. Express your results in joules and in electron volts. Are quantum effects important?

40.34 •• A harmonic oscillator with mass m and force constant k' is in an excited state that has quantum number n. (a) Let $p_{\text{max}} = mv_{\text{max}}$, where v_{max} is the maximum speed calculated in the Newtonian analysis of the oscillator. Derive an expression for p_{max} in terms of n, $\hbar$, k', and m. (b) Derive an expression for the classical amplitude A in terms of n, $\hbar$, k', and m. (c) If $\Delta x = A/\sqrt{2}$ and $\Delta p_x = p_{\text{max}}/\sqrt{2}$, what is the uncertainty product $\Delta x \Delta p_x$? How does the uncertainty product depend on n?

40.35 • Chemists use infrared absorption spectra to identify chemicals in a sample. In one sample, a chemist finds that light of wavelength 5.8 μm is absorbed when a molecule makes a transition from its ground harmonic oscillator level to its first excited level. (a) Find the energy of this transition. (b) If the molecule can be treated as a harmonic oscillator with mass 5.6×10^{-26} kg, find the force constant.

40.36 • A harmonic oscillator absorbs a photon of wavelength 6.50 μm when it undergoes a transition from the ground state to the first excited state. What is the ground-state energy, in electron volts, of the oscillator?

40.37 •• The ground-state energy of a harmonic oscillator is 5.80 eV. If the oscillator undergoes a transition from its $n = 3$ to $n = 2$ level by emitting a photon, what is the wavelength of the photon?

40.38 •• While undergoing a transition from the $n = 1$ to the $n = 2$ energy level, a harmonic oscillator absorbs a photon of wavelength 6.50 μm. What is the wavelength of the absorbed photon when this oscillator undergoes a transition (a) from the $n = 2$ to the $n = 3$ energy level and (b) from the $n = 1$ to the $n = 3$ energy level? (c) What is the value of $\sqrt{k'/m}$, the angular oscillation frequency of the corresponding Newtonian oscillator?

40.39 •• For the sodium atom of Example 40.8, find (a) the ground-state energy; (b) the wavelength of a photon emitted when the $n = 4$ to $n = 3$ transition occurs; (c) the energy difference for any $\Delta n = 1$ transition.

40.40 •• For the ground-level harmonic oscillator wave function $\psi(x)$ given in Eq. (40.47), $|\psi|^2$ has a maximum at $x = 0$. (a) Compute the ratio of $|\psi|^2$ at $x = +A$ to $|\psi|^2$ at $x = 0$, where A is given by Eq. (40.48) with $n = 0$ for the ground level. (b) Compute the ratio of $|\psi|^2$ at $x = +2A$ to $|\psi|^2$ at $x = 0$. In each case is your result consistent with what is shown in Fig. 40.27?

PROBLEMS

40.41 •• A particle of mass m in a one-dimensional box has the following wave function in the region $x = 0$ to $x = L$:

$$\Psi(x, t) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\psi_1(x)e^{-iE_1t/\hbar} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\psi_3(x)e^{-iE_3t/\hbar}$$

Here $\psi_1(x)$ and $\psi_3(x)$ are the normalized stationary-state wave functions for the $n = 1$ and $n = 3$ levels, and E_1 and E_3 are the energies of these levels. The wave function is zero for $x < 0$ and for $x > L$. (a) Find the value of the probability distribution function at $x = L/2$ as a function of time. (b) Find the angular frequency at which the probability distribution function oscillates.

40.42 •• Hydrogen emits radiation with four prominent visible wavelengths—one red, one cyan, one blue, and one violet. The respective frequencies are 656 nm, 486 nm, 434 nm, and 410 nm. We can model the hydrogen atom as an electron in a one-dimensional box, and attempt to match four adjacent emission lines in the predicted spectrum to the visible part of the hydrogen spectrum. (a) Determine the photon energies associated with the visible part of the hydrogen spectrum. (b) The electron-in-a-box emission spectrum is $E_{n_i \to n_f} = (n_i^2 - n_f^2)\epsilon$, where n_i and n_f are the initial and final quantum numbers of the electron when it drops to a lower energy level and ϵ is the energy determined

by the Schrödinger equation. What is the smallest possible value of n_i that can accommodate four emission lines? (c) Using the value from part (b) for n_i, estimate the order of magnitude of ϵ by dividing the four photon energies by the relevant differences $n_i^2 - n_f^2$ for transitions in the possible sets of (n_i, n_f) pairings. (d) Using Eq. (40.31) to identify ϵ, and using the mass of the electron, use your result from part (c) to estimate the length L of the box. (e) What is the ratio of your estimate of L to twice the Bohr radius? (*Note:* The hydrogen atom is better modeled using the Coulomb potential rather than as a particle in a box.)

40.43 •• **CALC** Consider a beam of free particles that move with velocity $v = p/m$ in the x-direction and are incident on a potential-energy step $U(x) = 0$, for $x < 0$, and $U(x) = U_0 < E$, for $x > 0$. The wave function for $x < 0$ is $\psi(x) = Ae^{ik_1x} + Be^{-ik_1x}$, representing incident and reflected particles, and for $x > 0$ is $\psi(x) = Ce^{ik_2x}$, representing transmitted particles. Use the conditions that both ψ and its first derivative must be continuous at $x = 0$ to find the constants B and C in terms of k_1, k_2, and A.

40.44 • **CALC** A particle is in the ground level of a box that extends from $x = 0$ to $x = L$. (a) What is the probability of finding the particle in the region between 0 and $L/4$? Calculate this by integrating $|\psi(x)|^2\,dx$, where ψ is normalized, from $x = 0$ to $x = L/4$. (b) What is the probability of finding the particle in the region $x = L/4$ to $x = L/2$? (c) How do the results of parts (a) and (b) compare? Explain. (d) Add the probabilities calculated in parts (a) and (b). (e) Are your results in parts (a), (b), and (d) consistent with Fig. 40.12b? Explain.

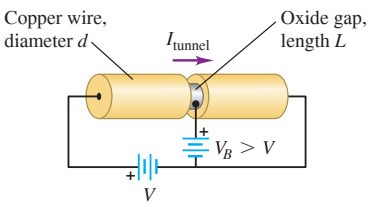
40.45 • **Photon in a Dye Laser.** An electron in a long, organic molecule used in a dye laser behaves approximately like a particle in a box with width 4.20 nm. What is the wavelength of the photon emitted when the electron undergoes a transition (a) from the first excited level to the ground level and (b) from the second excited level to the first excited level?

40.46 •• Consider a particle in a box with rigid walls at $x = 0$ and $x = L$. Let the particle be in the ground level. Calculate the probability $|\psi|^2dx$ that the particle will be found in the interval x to $x + dx$ for (a) $x = L/4$; (b) $x = L/2$; (c) $x = 3L/4$.

40.47 •• Repeat Problem 40.46 for a particle in the first excited level.

40.48 •• Suppose we have two copper wires that meet on either side of an oxide gap with length $L = 1$ nm, as shown in **Fig. P40.48**. If the left side is at a potential V relative to the right side, then we can estimate the tunneling current as follows: The wires have diameter $d = 1$ mm, and copper has $n = 8.5 \times 10^{28}$ free electrons per m^3. (a) Assume that the oxide gap provides a rectangular potential barrier of height 12 eV and that the energy of the free electrons incident on this barrier is 5.0 eV. Assume the gap has length $L = 1$ nm. What is the probability T that an electron will tunnel through the barrier? (b) A length x of wire on the left of the barrier will have nAx free electrons, where $A = \pi(d/2)^2$ is the cross-sectional area of the wire. In a similar length of wire on the right side of the barrier, the number of tunneled electrons will be T times that number. If these electrons move with effective velocity $v = dx/dt$, then what will be the tunneling current, expressed symbolically in terms of T, n, A, e, and v? (c) Define their effective speed v by $\frac{1}{2}mv^2 = eV$. The tunneled electrons have energy eV. What is their effective speed v, expressed symbolically in terms of e, V, and m, where m is the mass of an electron? (f) Put these elements together to estimate the tunneling current.

Figure **P40.48**



40.49 •• **CALC** What is the probability of finding a particle in a box of length L in the region between $x = L/4$ and $x = 3L/4$ when the particle is in (a) the ground level and (b) the first excited level? (*Hint:* Integrate $|\psi(x)|^2\,dx$, where ψ is normalized, between $L/4$ and $3L/4$.) (c) Are your results in parts (a) and (b) consistent with Fig. 40.12b? Explain.

40.50 •• The *penetration distance* η in a finite potential well is the distance at which the wave function has decreased to $1/e$ of the (b) wave function at the classical turning point:

$$\psi(x = L + \eta) = \frac{1}{e}\psi(L)$$

The penetration distance can be shown to be

$$\eta = \frac{\hbar}{\sqrt{2m(U_0 - E)}}$$

The probability of finding the particle beyond the penetration distance is nearly zero. (a) Find η for an electron having a kinetic energy of 13 eV in a potential well with $U_0 = 20$ eV. (b) Find η for a 20.0 MeV proton trapped in a 30.0-MeV-deep potential well.

40.51 •• **CALC** A fellow student proposes that a possible wave function for a free particle with mass m (one for which the potential-energy function $U(x)$ is zero) is

$$\psi(x) = \begin{cases} e^{+\kappa x}, & x < 0 \\ e^{-\kappa x}, & x \geq 0 \end{cases}$$

where κ is a positive constant. (a) Graph this proposed wave function. (b) Show that the proposed wave function satisfies the Schrödinger equation for $x < 0$ if the energy is $E = -\hbar^2\kappa^2/2m$—that is, if the energy of the particle is *negative*. (c) Show that the proposed wave function also satisfies the Schrödinger equation for $x \geq 0$ with the same energy as in part (b). (d) Explain why the proposed wave function is nonetheless *not* an acceptable solution of the Schrödinger equation for a free particle. (*Hint:* What is the behavior of the function at $x = 0$?) It is in fact impossible for a free particle (one for which $U(x) = 0$) to have an energy less than zero.

40.52 • An electron with initial kinetic energy 5.5 eV encounters a square potential barrier of height 10.0 eV. What is the width of the barrier if the electron has a 0.50% probability of tunneling through the barrier?

40.53 ••• **CP** Consider a one-dimensional lattice of carbon nuclei with interatomic spacing $d = 0.500$ nm. The potential energy of one nucleus due to electrostatic interaction with its two nearest neighbors is

$$V(x) = \frac{q^2}{4\pi\epsilon_0}\left(\frac{1}{d - x} + \frac{1}{d + x}\right)$$

where $q = 6e$ is the charge of each carbon nucleus and x is its position relative to its equilibrium position. (a) Sketch the potential $V(x)$ between $x = -d$ and $x = d$. (b) At low energy, the nucleus remains near its equilibrium position at $x = 0$ and the potential energy is well approximated as a harmonic oscillator. Use the power series in Appendix D to write $V(x)$ as a quadratic function in x, dropping contributions at higher order in x/d. (c) What is the spring constant k'? (d) What is the energy of the classical ground state, in eV? (e) What is the energy of the lowest-energy photons emitted when this system transitions between energy levels? (f) What is the wavelength of the corresponding radiation?

40.54 • **CP** A harmonic oscillator consists of a 0.022 kg mass on a spring. The oscillation frequency is 1.60 Hz, and the mass has a speed

of 0.390 m/s as it passes the equilibrium position. (a) What is the value of the quantum number n for its energy level? (b) What is the difference in energy between the levels E_n and E_{n+1}? Is this difference detectable?

40.55 • For small amplitudes of oscillation the motion of a pendulum is simple harmonic. For a pendulum with a period of 0.500 s, find the ground-level energy and the energy difference between adjacent energy levels. Express your results in joules and in electron volts. Are these values detectable?

40.56 •• **CALC** (a) Show by direct substitution in the Schrödinger equation for the one-dimensional harmonic oscillator that the wave function $\psi_1(x) = A_1 x e^{-\alpha^2 x^2/2}$, where $\alpha^2 = m\omega/\hbar$, is a solution with energy corresponding to $n = 1$ in Eq. (40.46). (b) Find the normalization constant A_1. (c) Show that the probability density has a minimum at $x = 0$ and maxima at $x = \pm 1/\alpha$, corresponding to the classical turning points for the ground state $n = 0$.

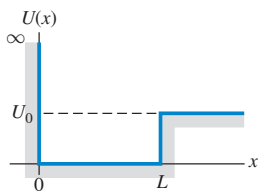
40.57 •• **CP** (a) The wave nature of particles results in the quantum-mechanical situation that a particle confined in a box can assume only wavelengths that result in standing waves in the box, with nodes at the box walls. Use this to show that an electron confined in a one-dimensional box of length L will have energy levels given by

$$E_n = \frac{n^2 h^2}{8mL^2}$$

(*Hint:* Recall that the relationship between the de Broglie wavelength and the speed of a nonrelativistic particle is $mv = h/\lambda$. The energy of the particle is $\frac{1}{2}mv^2$.) (b) If a hydrogen atom is modeled as a one-dimensional box with length equal to the Bohr radius, what is the energy (in electron volts) of the lowest energy level of the electron?

40.58 ••• Consider a potential well defined as $U(x) = \infty$ for $x < 0$, $U(x) = 0$ for $0 < x < L$, and $U(x) = U_0 > 0$ for $x > L$ (**Fig. P40.58**). Consider a particle with mass m and kinetic energy $E < U_0$ that is trapped in the well. (a) The boundary condition at the infinite wall $(x = 0)$ is $\psi(0) = 0$. What must the form of the function $\psi(x)$ for $0 < x < L$ be in order to satisfy both the Schrödinger equation and this boundary condition? (b) The wave function must remain finite as $x \to \infty$. What must the form of the function $\psi(x)$ for $x > L$ be in order to satisfy both the Schrödinger equation and this boundary condition at infinity? (c) Impose the boundary conditions that ψ and $d\psi/dx$ are continuous at $x = L$. Show that the energies of the allowed levels are obtained from solutions of the equation $k \cot kL = -\kappa$, where $k = \sqrt{2mE}/\hbar$ and $\kappa = \sqrt{2m(U_0 - E)}/\hbar$.

Figure **P40.58**



40.59 •• **DATA** In your research on new solid-state devices, you are studying a solid-state structure that can be modeled accurately as an electron in a one-dimensional infinite potential well (box) of width L. In one of your experiments, electromagnetic radiation is absorbed in transitions in which the initial state is the $n = 1$ ground state. You measure that light of frequency $f = 9.0 \times 10^{14}$ Hz is absorbed and that the next higher absorbed frequency is 16.9×10^{14} Hz. (a) What is quantum number n for the final state in each of the transitions that leads to the absorption of photons of these frequencies? (b) What is the width L of the potential well? (c) What is the longest wavelength in air of light that can be absorbed by an electron if it is initially in the $n = 1$ state?

40.60 •• **DATA** As an intern at a research lab, you study the transmission of electrons through a potential barrier. You know the height of the barrier, 8.0 eV, but must measure the width L of the barrier. When you measure the tunneling probability T as a function of the energy E of the electron, you get the results shown in the table.

E (eV)	4.0	5.0	6.0	7.0	7.6
T	2.4×10^{-6}	1.5×10^{-5}	1.2×10^{-4}	1.3×10^{-3}	8.1×10^{-3}

(a) For each value of E, calculate the quantities G and κ that appear in Eq. (40.42). Graph $\ln(T/G)$ versus κ. Explain why your data points, when plotted this way, fall close to a straight line. (b) Use the slope of the best-fit straight line to the data in part (a) to calculate L.

40.61 •• **DATA** When low-energy electrons pass through an ionized gas, electrons of certain energies pass through the gas as if the gas atoms weren't there and thus have transmission coefficients (tunneling probabilities) T equal to unity. The gas ions can be modeled approximately as a rectangular barrier. The value of $T = 1$ occurs when an integral or half-integral number of de Broglie wavelengths of the electron as it passes over the barrier equal the width L of the barrier. You are planning an experiment to measure this effect. To assist you in designing the necessary apparatus, you estimate the electron energies E that will result in $T = 1$. You assume a barrier height of 10 eV and a width of 1.8×10^{-10} m. Calculate the three lowest values of E for which $T = 1$.

40.62 ••• **CP** A particle is confined to move on a circle with radius R but is otherwise free. We can parameterize points on this circle by using the distance x from a reference point or by using the angle $\theta = x/R$. Since $x = 0$ and $x = 2\pi R$ describe the same point, the wave function must satisfy $\psi(x) = \psi(x + 2\pi R)$ and $\psi'(x) = \psi'(x + 2\pi R)$. (a) Solve the free-particle time-independent Schrödinger equation subject to these boundary conditions. You should find solutions $\psi_n^{\pm}$, where n is a positive integer and where lower n corresponds to lower energy. Express your solutions in terms of θ using unspecified normalization constants A_n^+ and A_n^- corresponding, respectively, to modes that move "counterclockwise" toward higher x and "clockwise" toward lower x. (b) Normalize these functions to determine $A_n^{\pm}$. (c) What are the energy levels E_n? (d) Write the time-dependent wave functions $\Psi_n^{\pm}(x, t)$ corresponding to $\Psi_n^{\pm}(x)$. Use the symbol ω for $E_1/\hbar$. (e) Consider the nonstationary state defined at $t = 0$ by $\Psi(x, 0) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}[\Psi_1^+(x) + \Psi_2^+(x)]$. Determine the probability density $|\Psi(x, t)|^2$ in terms of R, ω, and t. Simplify your result using the identity $1 + \cos\alpha = 2\cos^2(\alpha/2)$. (f) With what angular speed does the density peak move around the circle? (g) If the particle is an electron and the radius is the Bohr radius, then with what speed does its probability peak move?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS

40.63 ••• **CALC** The Schrödinger equation for the quantum-mechanical harmonic oscillator in Eq. (40.44) may be written as

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m}\psi'' + \frac{1}{2}m\omega^2 x^2 \psi = E\psi$$

where $\omega = \sqrt{k'/m}$ is the angular frequency for classical oscillations. Its solutions may be cleverly addressed using the following observations: The difference in applying two operations A and B, in opposite order, called a commutator, is denoted by $[A, B] = AB - BA$. For example, if A represents differentiation, so that $Af = \frac{df}{dx}$, where $f = f(x)$ is a function, and B represents multiplication by x, then $[A, B] = \left[\frac{d}{dx}, x\right]f = \frac{d}{dx}(xf) - x\frac{df}{dx}$. Applying the product rule for differentiation on the first term, we determine $\left[\frac{d}{dx}, x\right]f = f$, which

we summarize by writing $\left[\frac{d}{dx}, x\right] = 1$. Similarly, consider the two operators a_+ and a_- defined by $a_\pm = 1/\sqrt{2m\hbar\omega}\left(\mp\hbar\frac{d}{dx} + m\omega x\right)$. (a) Determine the commutator $[a_-, a_+]$. (b) Compute $a_+a_-\psi$ in terms of ψ and ψ'', where $\psi = \psi(x)$ is a wave function. Be mindful that $\frac{d}{dx}(x\psi) = \psi + x\psi'$. (c) The Schrödinger equation above may be written as $H\psi = E\psi$, where H is a differential operator. Use your previous result to write H in terms of a_+ and a_-. (d) Determine the commutators $[H, a_\pm]$. (e) Consider a wave function ψ_n with definite energy E_n, whereby $H\psi_n = E_n\psi_n$. If we define a new function $\psi_{n+1} = a_+\psi_n$, then we can readily determine its energy by computing $H\psi_{n+1} = Ha_+\psi_n = (a_+H + [H, a_+])\psi_n$ and comparing the result with $E_{n+1}\psi_{n+1}$. Finish this calculation by inserting what we have determined to find E_{n+1} in terms of E_n and n. (f) We can prove that the lowest-energy wave function ψ_0 is annihilated by a_-, meaning that $a_-\psi_0 = 0$. Using your expression for H in terms of $a_\pm$, determine the ground-state energy E_0. (g) By applying a_+ repeatedly, we can generate all higher states. The energy of the nth excited state can be determined by considering $Ha_+^n\psi_0 = E_0\psi_0$. Using the above results, determine E_n. (*Note:* We did not have to solve any differential equations or take any derivatives to determine the spectrum of this theory.)

40.64 ••• CALC The WKB Approximation. It can be a challenge to solve the Schrödinger equation for the bound-state energy levels of an arbitrary potential well. An alternative approach that can yield good approximate results for the energy levels is the *WKB approximation* (named for the physicists Gregor Wentzel, Hendrik Kramers, and Léon Brillouin, who pioneered its application to quantum mechanics). The WKB approximation begins from three physical statements: (i) According to de Broglie, the magnitude of momentum p of a quantum-mechanical particle is $p = h/\lambda$. (ii) The magnitude of momentum is related to the kinetic energy K by the relationship $K = p^2/2m$. (iii) If there are no nonconservative forces, then in Newtonian mechanics the energy E for a particle is constant and equal at each point to the sum of the kinetic and potential energies at that point: $E = K + U(x)$, where x is the coordinate. (a) Combine these three relationships to show that the wavelength of the particle at a coordinate x can be written as

$$\lambda(x) = \frac{h}{\sqrt{2m[E - U(x)]}}$$

Thus we envision a quantum-mechanical particle in a potential well $U(x)$ as being like a free particle, but with a wavelength $\lambda(x)$ that is a function of position. (b) When the particle moves into a region of increasing potential energy, what happens to its wavelength? (c) At a point where $E = U(x)$, Newtonian mechanics says that the particle has zero kinetic energy and must be instantaneously at rest. Such a point is called a *classical turning point,* since this is where a Newtonian particle must stop its motion and reverse direction. As an example, an object oscillating in simple harmonic motion with amplitude A moves back and forth between the points $x = -A$ and $x = +A$; each of these is a classical turning point, since there the potential energy $\frac{1}{2}k'x^2$ equals the total energy $\frac{1}{2}k'A^2$. In the WKB expression for $\lambda(x)$, what is the wavelength at a classical turning point? (d) For a particle in a box with length L, the walls of the box are classical turning points (see Fig. 40.8). Furthermore, the number of wavelengths that fit within the box must be a half-integer (see Fig. 40.10), so that $L = (n/2)\lambda$ and hence $L/\lambda = n/2$, where $n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots$. [Note that this is a restatement of Eq. (40.29).] The WKB scheme for finding the allowed bound-state energy levels of an *arbitrary* potential well is an extension of these observations. It demands that for an allowed energy E, there must be a half-integer number of wavelengths between the classical turning points for that energy. Since the wavelength in the WKB approximation is not a constant but depends on x, the number of wavelengths between the classical turning points a and b for a given value of the energy is the integral of $1/\lambda(x)$ between those points:

$$\int_a^b \frac{dx}{\lambda(x)} = \frac{n}{2} \quad (n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots)$$

Using the expression for $\lambda(x)$ you found in part (a), show that the *WKB condition for an allowed bound-state energy* can be written as

$$\int_a^b \sqrt{2m[E - U(x)]}\, dx = \frac{nh}{2} \quad (n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots)$$

(e) As a check on the expression in part (d), apply it to a particle in a box with walls at $x = 0$ and $x = L$. Evaluate the integral and show that the allowed energy levels according to the WKB approximation are the same as those given by Eq. (40.31). (*Hint:* Since the walls of the box are infinitely high, the points $x = 0$ and $x = L$ are classical turning points for *any* energy E. Inside the box, the potential energy is zero.) (f) For the finite square well shown in Fig. 40.13, show that the WKB expression given in part (d) predicts the *same* bound-state energies as for an infinite square well of the same width. (*Hint:* Assume $E < U_0$. Then the classical turning points are at $x = 0$ and $x = L$.) This shows that the WKB approximation does a poor job when the potential-energy function changes discontinuously, as for a finite potential well. In the next two problems we consider situations in which the potential-energy function changes gradually and the WKB approximation is much more useful.

40.65 ••• CALC The WKB approximation (see Challenge Problem 40.64) can be used to calculate the energy levels for a harmonic oscillator. In this approximation, the energy levels are the solutions to the equation

$$\int_a^b \sqrt{2m[E - U(x)]}\, dx = \frac{nh}{2} \quad n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots$$

Here E is the energy, $U(x)$ is the potential-energy function, and $x = a$ and $x = b$ are the classical turning points (the points at which E is equal to the potential energy, so the Newtonian kinetic energy would be zero). (a) Determine the classical turning points for a harmonic oscillator with energy E and force constant k'. (b) Carry out the integral in the WKB approximation and show that the energy levels in this approximation are $E_n = \hbar\omega$, where $\omega = \sqrt{k'/m}$ and $n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots$. (*Hint:* Recall that $\hbar = h/2\pi$. A useful standard integral is

$$\int \sqrt{A^2 - x^2}\, dx = \tfrac{1}{2}\left[x\sqrt{A^2 - x^2} + A^2 \arcsin\left(\frac{x}{|A|}\right)\right]$$

where arcsin denotes the inverse sine function. Note that the integrand is even, so the integral from $-x$ to x is equal to twice the integral from 0 to x.) (c) How do the approximate energy levels found in part (b) compare with the true energy levels given by Eq. (40.46)? Does the WKB approximation give an underestimate or an overestimate of the energy levels?

40.66 ••• CALC Protons, neutrons, and many other particles are made of more fundamental particles called *quarks* and *antiquarks* (the antimatter equivalent of quarks). A quark and an antiquark can form a bound state with a variety of different energy levels, each of which corresponds to a different particle observed in the laboratory. As an example, the ψ particle is a low-energy bound state of a so-called charm quark and its antiquark, with a rest energy of 3097 MeV; the $\psi(2S)$ particle is

an excited state of this same quark–antiquark combination, with a rest energy of 3686 MeV. A simplified representation of the potential energy of interaction between a quark and an antiquark is $U(x) = A|x|$, where A is a positive constant and x represents the distance between the quark and the antiquark. You can use the WKB approximation (see Challenge Problem 40.64) to determine the bound-state energy levels for this potential-energy function. In the WKB approximation, the energy levels are the solutions to the equation

$$\int_a^b \sqrt{2m[E - U(x)]}\, dx = \frac{nh}{2} \quad (n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots)$$

Here E is the energy, $U(x)$ is the potential-energy function, and $x = a$ and $x = b$ are the classical turning points (the points at which E is equal to the potential energy, so the Newtonian kinetic energy would be zero). (a) Determine the classical turning points for the potential $U(x) = A|x|$ and for an energy E. (b) Carry out the above integral and show that the allowed energy levels in the WKB approximation are given by

$$E_n = \frac{1}{2m}\left(\frac{3mAh}{4}\right)^{2/3} n^{2/3} \quad (n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots)$$

(*Hint:* The integrand is even, so the integral from $-x$ to x is equal to twice the integral from 0 to x.) (c) Does the difference in energy between successive levels increase, decrease, or remain the same as n increases? How does this compare to the behavior of the energy levels for the harmonic oscillator? For the particle in a box? Can you suggest a simple rule that relates the difference in energy between successive levels to the shape of the potential-energy function?

MCAT-STYLE PASSAGE PROBLEMS

Quantum Dots. A *quantum dot* is a type of crystal so small that quantum effects are significant. One application of quantum dots is in fluorescence imaging, in which a quantum dot is bound to a molecule or structure of interest. When the quantum dot is illuminated with light, it absorbs photons and then re-emits photons at a different wavelength. This phenomenon is called *fluorescence*. The wavelength that a quantum dot emits when stimulated with light depends on the dot's size, so the synthesis of quantum dots with different photon absorption and emission properties may be possible. We can understand many quantum-dot properties via a model in which a particle of mass M (roughly the mass of the electron) is confined to a two-dimensional rigid square box of sides L. In this model, the quantum-dot energy levels are given by $E_{m,n} = (m^2 + n^2)(\pi^2\hbar^2)/2ML^2$, where m and n are integers 1, 2, 3, ...

40.67 According to this model, which statement is true about the energy-level spacing of dots of different sizes? (a) Smaller dots have equally spaced levels, but larger dots have energy levels that get farther apart as the energy increases. (b) Larger dots have greater spacing between energy levels than do smaller dots. (c) Smaller dots have greater spacing between energy levels than do larger dots. (d) The spacing between energy levels is independent of the dot size.

40.68 When a given dot with side length L makes a transition from its first excited state to its ground state, the dot emits green (550 nm) light. If a dot with side length $1.1L$ is used instead, what wavelength is emitted in the same transition, according to this model? (a) 600 nm; (b) 670 nm; (c) 500 nm; (d) 460 nm.

40.69 Dots that are the same size but made from different materials are compared. In the same transition, a dot of material 1 emits a photon of longer wavelength than the dot of material 2 does. Based on this model, what is a possible explanation? (a) The mass of the confined particle in material 1 is greater. (b) The mass of the confined particle in material 2 is greater. (c) The confined particles make more transitions per second in material 1. (d) The confined particles make more transitions per second in material 2.

40.70 One advantage of the quantum dot is that, compared to many other fluorescent materials, excited states have relatively long lifetimes (10 ns). What does this mean for the spread in the energy of the photons emitted by quantum dots? (a) Quantum dots emit photons of more well-defined energies than do other fluorescent materials. (b) Quantum dots emit photons of less well-defined energies than do other fluorescent materials. (c) The spread in the energy is affected by the size of the dot, not by the lifetime. (d) There is no spread in the energy of the emitted photons, regardless of the lifetime.

ANSWERS

Chapter Opening Question ?

(i) When an electron in one of these particles—called *quantum dots*—makes a transition from an excited level to a lower level, it emits a photon whose energy is equal to the difference in energy between the levels. The smaller the quantum dot, the larger the energy spacing between levels and hence the shorter (bluer) the wavelength of the emitted photons. See Example 40.6 (Section 40.3) for more details.

Key Example VARIATION Problems

VP40.4.1 (a) 0.549 nm (b) $E_2 = 8.00 \times 10^{-19}$ J, $E_3 = 1.80 \times 10^{-18}$ J

VP40.4.2 (a) 3.94×10^{-12} J (b) 6.57×10^{-12} J

VP40.4.3 (a) 3.03×10^{-19} J (b) 0.772 nm (c) 393 nm

VP40.4.4 (a) $\dfrac{d^2\psi(x)}{dx^2} = -\dfrac{2mE}{\hbar^2}A\cos\left(\dfrac{x\sqrt{2mE}}{\hbar} + \phi\right) = -\dfrac{2mE}{\hbar^2}\psi(x)$, so $-\dfrac{\hbar^2}{2m}\dfrac{d^2\psi(x)}{dx^2} = E\psi(x)$ (b) $\phi = \pm\pi/2$ (c) $\dfrac{L\sqrt{2mE}}{\hbar} = n\pi$, so $E = \dfrac{n^2\pi^2\hbar^2}{2mL^2}$, where $n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots$

VP40.6.1 (a) 4.92×10^{-19} J (b) 3.07×10^{-19} J (c) 2.64×10^{-18} J

VP40.6.2 (a) 9.40×10^{-20} J (b) 5.64×10^{-19} J (c) 0.800 nm

VP40.6.3 (a) initial $n = 3$, final $n = 1$ (b) 596 nm for initial $n = 3$, final $n = 2$; 878 nm for initial $n = 2$, final $n = 1$

VP40.6.4 (a) 2.35 eV (b) 0.010 eV

VP40.7.1 (a) 2.90×10^{-5} (b) 1.47×10^{-3}

VP40.7.2 (a) 5.33×10^{-3} (b) 0.704 nm

VP40.7.3 (a) 2.54×10^{-4} (b) 8.59×10^{-4} (c) 3.46×10^{-3}

VP40.7.4 0.509 nm

Bridging Problem

(a) $$|\Psi(x,t)|^2 = \frac{1}{L}\left[\sin^2\frac{\pi x}{L} + \sin^2\frac{2\pi x}{L} + 2\sin\frac{\pi x}{L}\sin\frac{2\pi x}{L}\cos\left(\frac{(E_2 - E_1)t}{\hbar}\right)\right]$$

(b) no

(d) $\dfrac{3\pi^2\hbar}{2mL^2}$

(e) $\dfrac{0.903\pi^2\hbar}{mL^2}$